

PRIYA RANJAN
Joint Secretary



सत्यमेव जयते



आज़ादी का
अमृत महोत्सव

भारत सरकार

कृषि एवं किसान कल्याण मंत्रालय

कृषि एवं किसान कल्याण विभाग

Government of India

Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare

DO No. - 14-33/2022-Fert.Use

Date- 27.02.2023

Dear Colleague,

You are aware that the Centrally Sponsored Soil Health Card (SHC) and Soil Health Management (SHM) Schemes were introduced as sub-schemes of National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA) under Umbrella Scheme- Green Revolution-Krishonnati in Agriculture Sector during 2014-15. The main objective of the Schemes was to encourage judicious use of fertilisers in conjunction with organic & bio-fertilisers. SHC provide information to farmers on nutrient status of their soil along with recommendation on appropriate dosage of nutrients to be applied for improving soil health fertility and productivity.

This objective has been achieved through a large network of Soil Testing Laboratories both in Government and private sector. This scheme is now being implemented as a component "Soil Health & Fertility" of Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY) from the year 2022-23. This Department vide letter dated 20.01.2023 has circulated revised procedure of formulating Annual Action Plan for the Schemes implemented by it. The Principal Secretary Agriculture/ ACS Agriculture/Agriculture Production Commissioner will be the nodal officer for all the schemes of DA&FW. A presentation of overall AAP for the agriculture sector of the state will be done by the State Agriculture Secretary to Government of India and the comments of Gol will be given in meeting itself and minuted. The final approval of the consolidated AAP with the comments of Gol will be approved by SLSC headed by Chief Secretary of the State. Tentative allocation of funds has also been communicated by this Department as EFC has approved the EFC note and final approval of Cabinet is underway. In view of the changed scenario, the Soil Health and Fertility Component under RKVY will be implemented by State Governments as per circular issued or guidelines provided and State Government will enjoy more flexibility to implement the scheme.

2. In order to make the schemes more farmer friendly and assist the State Government to implement Soil Health and Fertility Scheme, the Government of India has made some technological interventions.

- The Soil Health Card portal has been revamped and integrated with a GIS system so that all the test results will be captured and can be seen on a map.
- Introduction of a mobile application for easy hassle free QR code enabled soil sampling and testing The QR code based soil sample collection app has been developed by the Ministry as a reference app which can be directly used by the state governments or they can develop / build their own app and integrate it with SHC portal through APIs.
- Focus on providing service at the doorstep to the farmers by encouraging and facilitating soil testing facilities at a local level through entrepreneurs, SHGs, Cooperatives, Schools, FPOs etc.

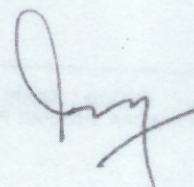
- Data parameters for collection of soil data have been standardized to allow use of certified/validated equipment in a decentralised manner.
- The States are requested to link up all the existing and new soil testing labs for automatic transmission of test data to the georeferenced platform. Till date the data with regard to sample collection and sample analysis has been entered manually by the States. However, now in new procedure the data will be automatically fetched by the system on a real time basis after the test is conducted.
- The existing Soil Health Portal <https://soilhealth.dac.gov.in> has been totally revamped to monitor physical and financial progress of various components of the Scheme in the respective States.

3. In addition to this, DA&FW has constituted a committee with all the organizations related to Soil Health and State Universities to bring about a **National One Soil Unified Information System** which may be easily accessible to farmers, policy makers, academia, researchers and also to the stakeholders operating in the ecosystem. This committee will work out a mechanism for convergence and interoperability of data related to soil resources across different organisations in the country and develops standards for data framework. The committee will work on the strategy to take forward the development of Digital Soil Resource Map of India. Decision support system for farmers and stakeholders will be developed and an interface for farmers and other stakeholders will be provided.

4. In order to develop the soil fertility map, Government of India has decided to conduct 5 Crore Soil Samples across the country during year 2023-24 to 2025-26. States should prepare Annual Action Plan keeping in mind that during these three years they have to conduct atleast 200 soil samples testing in each Gram Panchayat on an average. These figures will vary according to the area of the Panchayat. On an average, out of these 200 soil tests, 100 tests will be done under the SHC Scheme through the State with the help of Village Level Entrepreneur / own machinery/ FPOs/SHGs/ Schools etc. for which Rs. 300 (CSS in the sharing of 60:40 of Centre and State) from the scheme will be provided to State. State will ensure priority to small and marginal farmers and try to cover all types of land in a Gram Panchayat (G.P.). Under the scheme for upto 100 additional tests to be done through Village Level Entrepreneur (VLEs) in the GP, for which farmers will have to pay to VLE Rs. 20 will be given as incentive from the scheme to that VLE for each test. The VLE will be obligated to use the SHC App. and portal to upload the test results in SHC portal and once he does this he will be provided the incentive of Rs. 20 per soil test. All such samples will be tested and a fertility map on GIS platform all over the country will be generated. State will decide the physical distance between two tests performed so that test will be equally distributed all over the GP.

5. To make the implementation/monitoring of the Scheme smooth and to facilitate farmers an easy access to his soil health card, the mobile application has been made robust with the following additional features:

- Restrict the sample collection region for the VLE/operator collecting the soil sample
- Auto selection of the latitude and longitude of the location
- Generation of a QR code to link with the sample



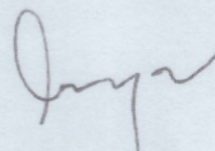
- Prevents erroneous entry of non-agricultural region coordinates (eg. Settlements, Waterbodies etc.,)
- Test results of all samples directly on the portal from the geo-mapped labs, without any manual intervention.

The user manual of mobile application/portal and dashboard is enclosed for ready reference. There will be four types of Users i.e. central, state, district and Soil Testing Laboratories/VLEs on the portal. Manufacturers of mini soil testing labs would also be registered on the portal. Whereas mini/village level soil testing labs are required to be updated in order to make compliant with new mobile app in order to place data directly on the portal, analysis reports generated by static soil testing labs would be shared through APIs on the portal. IARI-ICAR has already initiated exercise to update the mini/village level soil testing labs. DA&FW has already created State Level authorities on the portal and User mail ids and passwords in this regard are also being shared.

6. In order to ensure seamless and effective implementation of the new soil testing regime and to achieve the above objectives, State Governments are expected to undertake following activities:-

	Activities	Timelines
(i)	Enrolment of Users under the State Level authority by a registration process	15/03/2023
(ii)	Creation of District Level authorities by the State Level authorities	25/03/2023 (after attending the Training.)
(iii)	Enrolment of Users under the District Level authority by a registration process	31/03/2023 (District level users need to register themselves, state authorities need to approve.)
(iv)	Assigning necessary permissions to users by the State/District level authorities to manage their respective roles.	15/3//2023 (Permissions already inbuilt)
(v)	Mapping of Soil Testing Labs/Mini/village level Soil Testing labs	15/4/2023 (District users need to do it in the portal)
(vi)	Registration of lab operators, VLEs etc.	15/4/2023 (District users need to do it in the portal)
(vii)	Training of State Level/District Level authorities	1/3/2023 to 31/3/2023

7. DA&FW has planned extensive trainings for users at different levels, a tentative schedule for these trainings, in virtual mode, is also being enclosed herewith. The portal/mobile



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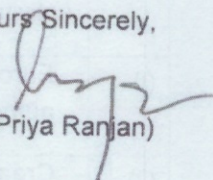
NOTE 16 (Attachment : Circular of implementation of Soil Health Card(5)_compressed.pdf)

app has been developed by M/s Klonec Automation System Private limited, Shri Sandeep Kondaji, Tel: 180-010-34112 mail id shc.support@krishitantra.com/sandeep.kondaji@krishitantra.com may be contacted for any technical assistance, if required. For administrative issue State can contact, Director (INM) Tel. No. 23382546 email - rajni.taneja66@gov.in and US (INM) Tel. No. 23381191, email - chandra.sp@nic.in . States are expected to prepare master trainers for the same, so that they can further impart training as and when required by the State. If there will be need to organize regional workshop, state may send request in this regard and the training programme will be organized for the state officials.

8. I shall be grateful if states take appropriate timely action in this regard and coordinate with various authorities/users in order to ensure operationalisation of the revamped portal at the earliest.

With regards

Yours Sincerely,


(Priya Ranjan)

To,

The Principal Secretary Agriculture/ ACS Agriculture/Agriculture Production Commissioner of all States.

Copy to -All Nodal Officers of Soil Health and Fertility in States/UTs

Training Schedule:-

State/ Union Territories	Date & Time	Trainers
Delhi	01/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Jammu & Kashmir	01/03/2023 10:00AM-1:00 PM	Team B
Haryana	01/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Himachal Pradesh	02/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Assam	02/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Bihar	02/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Arunachal Pradesh	03/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Andhra Pradesh	03/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Telangana	03/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Madhya Pradesh	06/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Gujarat	06/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Maharashtra	06/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Goa	07/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Karnataka	07/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Kerala	07/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Rajasthan	09/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Punjab	09/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Jharkhand	09/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C

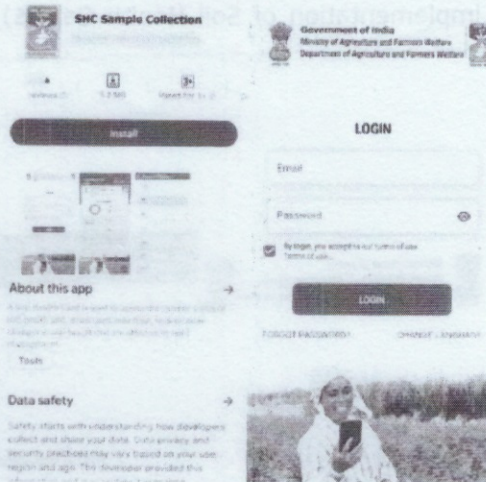
Meghalaya	10/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Manipur	10/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Mizoram	10/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Sikkim	13/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Odisha	13/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Nagaland	13/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Tripura	14/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Tamilnadu	14/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Uttar Pradesh	14/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
West Bengal	15/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Lakshadweep	15/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Andaman & Nicobar	15/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Dadra Nagar Haveli Daman Diu	16/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Puducherry	16/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Ladakh	16/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Additional Slot 1	17/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A
Additional Slot 2	17/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Additional Slot 3	17/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C
Additional Slot 4	20/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team A

Additional Slot 5	20/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team B
Additional Slot 6	20/03/2023 10:00AM-12:00 PM	Team C

SHC Mobile App

App Install

[illegible]



You can also download the SHC App by visiting Android playstore and search for SHC Soil Sample Collection.

Click Install App.

Login

- Open the SHC mobile application
- You will be navigated to login page with input fields as “Email” and “Password”
- Fill out all the credentials and make sure that by default the checkbox “By login, you accept to our Terms of use...” is marked or not, if not need mark the check box
- Click on “LOGIN” button

Forgot password

- If you wish to change your password, click on the “FORGOT PASSWORD?” present in the login page itself.
- After this, you will be navigated to the forgot password page
- Need to enter the email Id to which the reset password will be sent
- Click on the “SUBMIT” button

Change language

- If you want to change the language which you want to prefer, click on “CHANGE LANGUAGE” button.
- After this, you will be navigated to change language page
- Here you need to choose one language whichever you want. Click on “OK” button
- The App language can be changed also from the login page.

Registration of farmers

Need to add details of the farmer for whom this soil sample test is being conducted. The procedure to add the details of the farmers is as follows:

- Click on the “Farmer Registration” button present on the home page
- Add the details of the farmer:
 - Name of the farmer
 - Mobile number of the farmer
 - Email(Optional)
 - Adhaar number of the farmer
 - Preferred language of the farmer
 - Address of the farmer: The select location is integrated with Google Maps and on clicking this field, a map view is generated and the user can pinpoint his/her location.
- Click on “ADD NEW FARMER” button

The image shows two side-by-side screenshots of the Soil Health Card (SHC) application interface. The left screenshot displays the home page with a 'Farmer Registration' button highlighted. The right screenshot shows the registration form with the following fields: Name, Mobile Number (with a dropdown for IN +91), Email (Optional), Adhaar, Preferred Language (dropdown), Select Location (dropdown), and Address. A 'Successfully created farmer.' message is visible at the bottom of the form, and an 'ADD NEW FARMER' button is at the bottom.

Generate QR Code

Login to SHC Admin Panel using VLE login. VLE users can generate QR codes for collecting soil samples in advance and print them in bulk.